A-A-53143
21 August 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WIRE CUTTER, EAR (Guilford-Wright)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers an ear wire cutter of the Guilford-Wright design suitable for microsurgical ear procedures.

Salient characteristics.

General. The wire cutter shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Style and design. The wire cutter shall have a scissors-type design approximately 3-1/2 inches in length with a 10 mm cutting blade. The wire cutter shall have finger ring handles and shall be in conformance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing 23386.

Performance. The wire cutter shall be capable of cutting 316 stainless steel ear wire snares up to 0.04 inch diameter without exerting excess force on the wire cutter.

Material. The wire cutter shall be fabricated of Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

Passivation. The wire cutter shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion. The wire cutter shall show no corrosion or copper plating when subjected to tests specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Hardness. The wire cutter shall be hardened and have a Rockwell hardness of C-50 to C-55 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Finish. The finish shall be satin or matte. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform, non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Identification markings. The wire cutter shall bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless." Instruments of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. The wire cutter shall be free from burrs, cracks, scale, corrosion, or other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that the design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One wire cutter, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one wire cutter. Sampling shall be Level I with an AQL of 2.5.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one wire cutter. Sampling shall be Level S-2 with an AQL of 2.5.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the lastest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made toa the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-8748	WIRE CUTTER, EAR, (Guilford-Wright)

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-ME

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-3925

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

'RUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in ıtting comments and suggestions for improvements All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide ₄gestrons This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)* and mailed In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

[illegible] LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN. DPSC-RSIS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
1-A-53113	WIRE CUTTER, EAR (Guilford-Wright)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify)

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI – Optional)	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.